Seattle
Office of Sustainability
& Environment

Seattle Building Emissions Performance Standard

GHGI Targets & Emissions Factors (JANUARY 2026)

Seattle's Building Emissions Performance Standard (BEPS) law establishes emissions intensity targets that large buildings must meet starting as early as 2031. This factsheet lists the greenhouse gas emissions intensity targets (GHGITs) and emissions factors for the requirements.

BEPS Greenhouse Gas Emissions Intensity Targets (GHGITs)

GHGITs by Building Activity Type (From 2025 Director's Rule Table 4)				
	GHGITs ($kgCO_2e$/SF/yr) by compliance interval			
Building Activity Type	**2031–2035**	**2036–2040**[1]	**2041–2045**[1, 2]	**2046–2050**[1, 3]
College/University	2.69	*1.57*	*0.00*	*0.00*
Data Center[4]	1.43	*0.83*	*0.00*	*0.00*
Entertainment/Public Assembly	1.18	*0.69*	*0.00*	*0.00*
Fire/Police Station	2.23	*1.30*	*0.00*	*0.00*
Hospital	4.68	*2.73*	*0.00*	*0.00*
Hotel	2.06	*1.20*	*0.00*	*0.00*
K-12 School	0.95	*0.56*	*0.00*	*0.00*
Laboratory[1]	*6.30*	*3.68*	*0.00*	*0.00*
Medical Office[4]	2.11	*1.23*	*0.00*	*0.00*
Multifamily Housing[3,5]	0.89	*0.63*	*0.37*	*0.00*
Museum[4]	2.11	*1.23*	*0.00*	*0.00*
Non-Refrigerated Warehouse	0.77	*0.45*	*0.00*	*0.00*
Office	0.81	*0.47*	*0.00*	*0.00*
Other	2.48	*1.45*	*0.00*	*0.00*
Recreation	3.22	*1.88*	*0.00*	*0.00*
Refrigerated Warehouse	0.98	*0.57*	*0.00*	*0.00*
Residence Hall/Dormitory	1.16	*0.68*	*0.00*	*0.00*
Restaurant	5.73	*3.34*	*0.00*	*0.00*
Retail Store	1.03	*0.60*	*0.00*	*0.00*
Self-Storage Facility	0.31	*0.18*	*0.00*	*0.00*
Senior Living Community	2.11	*1.23*	*0.00*	*0.00*
Services	1.36	*0.79*	*0.00*	*0.00*
Supermarket/Grocery Store	3.42	*2.00*	*0.00*	*0.00*
Worship Facility	1.20	*0.70*	*0.00*	*0.00*

1 — Laboratory target will be revised by rule in 2027, based on further evaluation.
2 — Net-zero emissions by 2041–2045 for nonresidential.
3 — Net-zero emissions by 2046–2050 for multifamily housing.
4 — Building activity types and GHGITs added by 2025 Director's Rule.
5 — Pursuant to SMC 22.925.110, owners of low-income housing, human service use, and low-rent housing may receive an extension from meeting the GHGITs in 2031–2035 but still must meet benchmarking verification and all other reporting obligations for 2031–2035.

Target Updates

Seattle's building stock, as well as available technology, will inevitably change and grow over the next two to three decades. Additionally, other laws, such as the WA State Climate Commitment Act, Clean Energy Transformation Act, and updates to the State's Clean Building Performance Standard may impact how Seattle buildings operate. To accommodate such changes, the BEPS law sets *required* GHGITs only for the 2031–2035 compliance interval. The OSE Director has the authority to revise the GHGITs for 2036–2040 and later by rule, based on building performance data, evolving technology, additional regulations, or other relevant factors. Revising the future GHGITs will include stakeholder engagement via rulemaking and is expected to start in 2030.

Calculating the Greenhouse Gas Emissions Intensity (GHGI) and Target

A qualified person,[1] working on behalf of the building owner, will calculate a covered building's greenhouse gas intensity (GHGI) to determine if it meets the applicable GHGIT. The GHGI is calculated using the total weather-normalized building consumption of each energy source, multiplied by the energy source's emissions factor, and divided by the square footage of the building. A building with multiple uses' GHGIT is a weighted average (by square footage) of the multiple Building Activity Type GHGITs. Details for all calculations are in Section 12 of the 2025 Director's Rule. The City is currently developing online reporting tools for calculations and reporting.

GHG Emissions Factors

Emissions factors show the greenhouse gas emissions from a given energy source emits on a per unit basis. BEPS includes greenhouse gas emissions factors to be used when calculating a building's GHGI. Both the emissions factors for calculating a baseline GHGI and the provisional factors for 2031–2035 are listed in the table below. The emissions factors for energy sources may change over time, so the Director may revise the 2031–2035 factors by Dec. 31, 2027, by rule, and every five years thereafter for later compliance intervals.

Greenhouse Gas Emissions Factors (From 2025 Director's Rule Table 5)		
Energy source	Emissions factors ($kgCO_2e/kBtu$)	
	A. For baseline GHGI & for 2027–2030 compliance interval (2019–2030 energy data)	**B.** *Provisional* for 2031–2035 compliance interval[1] (2029–2035 energy data)
Seattle City Light electricity	.0058	.0029
Puget Sound Energy natural gas	.053	.053
CenTrio district thermal energy	.081	.081
1 — Provisional emissions factors will be confirmed by rule by December 31, 2027.		

Other fossil fuels: Emission factors for fuels such as heating oil, propane, etc. will reference the US EPA.[2]

Comparing ESPM Building / Space Types to BEPS Building Activity Types

Energy Star Portfolio Manager (ESPM) categories for how a building or space is used (Building/Space Types) can be readily translated to BEPS building activity type GHGI targets. To see which ESPM Building/Space Type translates to a given BEPS Building Activity Type, use the Director's Rule reference table in Appendix A. The City's forthcoming reporting tools will also make this straightforward.

Learn more about BEPS

Contact cleanbuildings@seattle.gov or visit seattle.gov/building-emissions-performance-standard.

[1] A "qualified person" means a person having training, expertise and at least three years professional experience in building energy use analysis and one of several certifications or licenses. Please refer to the ordinance definitions for details.
[2] See the EPA GHG Emissions Factors Hub.